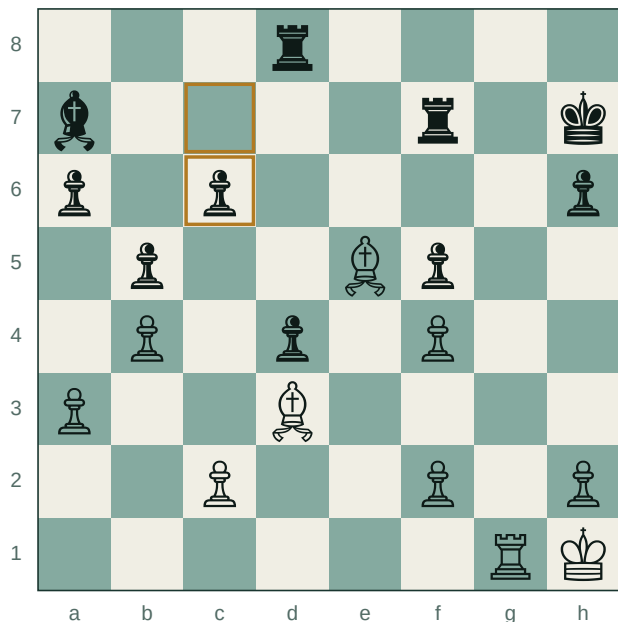


Discovered checks: White, move 31

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 30...c6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Bxf5+ Rxf5 32. Rg7+ Kh8 33. Rd7+ Kg8 34. Rxd8+

31.Bxf5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on f5. Recorded reply: **31...Rxf5**.

32.Rg7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g7 it attacks king on h7 and bishop on a7. Recorded reply: **32...Kh8**.

33.Rd7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From d7 it attacks rook on d8 and bishop on a7. Recorded reply: **33...Kg8**.

34.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on f5.